

MARÍA ALEXANDRA GALARZA GALLARDO

Frontend Developer | UX/UI mindset | Code Review & Mentoring

ABOUT ME

Frontend developer specialized in React with experience in technical leadership, code review, and mentoring in intensive training environments. Over the past few years, I have designed web development programs and supported hundreds of developers in building real-world projects, which has enabled me to develop strong expertise in best practices, software architecture, and debugging.

My background combines frontend development, UX/UI design, and a foundation in architecture, allowing me to build clear, maintainable, and user-centered interfaces. In my work, I prioritize accessibility, code quality, and efficiency, applying green software principles and best practices that contribute to more sustainable and usable digital products. I have also worked on real-world projects developing applications with React and Next.js, contributing to frontend development as well as backend integrations, APIs, and business logic when required. I am currently looking to consolidate my career as a frontend developer within a product team or applied research environment, where I can contribute both technical expertise and a structured approach to software development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Frontend Developer & Technical Lead

Factoría F5 Association, October 2022 - Present

I lead the FemCoders Barcelona training program in fullstack web development, designing the complete technical roadmap and guiding teams in building real-world applications using agile methodologies. My work has been primarily focused on systematically reviewing code from projects developed with JavaScript, React, Java, and Spring Boot to ensure quality, best practices, and maintainability.

Throughout this process, I have developed a strong ability to identify recurring errors, improve code structure, provide coherent architectural guidance, and help solve complex problems related to API consumption and development. I have also supported teams in technical decision-making, acting as a key reference within the training environment.

This role has also involved one-to-one mentoring, guided debugging sessions, and the definition of development standards, contributing significantly to improving the technical quality of projects and preparing students for professional environments.

Frontend developer & Technical Assistant

Factoría F5 Association, May to October 2022

Supported the training process of web development bootcamps by applying development best practices. I reinforced key transferable skills for employment, continuous learning, and entrepreneurship for people in vulnerable situations.

Staff Frontend Engineer

SheHub, October to December 2025

I participated in the design of the project's frontend architecture, defining folder structures, naming conventions, and development standards focused on scalability and code maintainability. I advised the team on technical decisions related to frontend organization, component reuse, and best practices in system design.

In parallel, I acted as a technical mentor, supporting developers in problem-solving, debugging, and improving their implementations.

Frontend Developer & UI Designer

Freelance projects y collaborations, 2021 - Present

I have worked on the development of frontend interfaces across different projects, combining technical implementation with user experience design.

In the Red PHI Ecuador project, I designed, developed, and maintained a web application using React and Next.js, including CI/CD deployment automation. I have also built custom interfaces such as the website for artist Estela Julia, incorporating management dashboards and tailored solutions adapted to client needs. Additionally, I have developed WordPress projects using Elementor for the architecture company LegoArquitect, showcasing their services.

These projects have allowed me to work in real-world environments, applying best development practices, frontend application structuring, and making design decisions focused on usability and maintainability.

UI Designer

Tikibike, May 2021

I collaborated on the redesign of the user interface for a bicycle travel platform, improving information clarity and the overall user experience using tools such as Figma, Illustrator, and Photoshop.

Architect

Área Metropolitana de Barcelona (AMB), April 2017 to July 2020

I worked on infrastructure and territorial systems projects, collaborating with technical teams on the management of geospatial information and the development of strategic documentation. This experience allowed me to develop strong skills in systems thinking, multidisciplinary coordination, and structuring complex information, which I now apply to software development.

OTHER PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE (ARCHITECTURE & PROJECT MANAGEMENT)

2008 – 2017

During this time, I have worked on a variety of projects and roles related to architecture, design, and project management, strengthening skills such as leadership, team coordination, project management, communication, and adaptability.

- I managed the cadastral part of the e-GAD project in Ecuador, integrating management and GIS. Coordinated with the technical team to optimize user flow and designed the interface for an intuitive and coherent user experience.
- I participated in architecture studies, contributing to the improvement of creative and strategic processes for planning and designing functional and aesthetically aligned solutions tailored to client needs.
- I was involved in large-scale infrastructure projects such as Quito Airport, developing technical skills, contractor management capabilities, and experience in coordinating multidisciplinary teams.
- I directed the decentralized valuation and cadastre department, leading the team and implementing process improvements that optimized delivery times and strengthened quality control of cadastral information systems.
- I have also led and collaborated on entrepreneurial ventures, managing digital content, UX/UI design, web development, and brand development, working with a broad client portfolio.
- In addition, I delivered technical training and lectures, consolidating my experience in communication, mentoring, and knowledge transfer.

EDUCATION

- Application Development with web Technologies Professional Certificate - Soc, 2026
- Qualification for teaching in grades A, B and C of the professional training system - SOC, 2025
- User Experience Design - Google.org (240 hours), 2022
- Front-end web development specialized in React.js - IT Academy (352 hours), 2022
- Full-stack web development - Factoría F5 (850 hours), 2021
- Front-end web development - Factoría F5 (300 hours), 2020
- Master in Intervention and environmental management: people and society - Universidad de Barcelona (75 ECTS), 2022
- Master in Sustainable intervention in the built environment - Universidad Politécnica de Cataluña (60 ECTS), 2017
- Architecture degree - Universidad Católica del Ecuador, 2009

COURSES

- Artificial Intelligence Introductory Level: Learning with Python - Eurecat (24 hours), February to March 2025
- Introduction to Python Programming - Eurecat (50 hours), October to November 2023
- Green Software for Practitioners - Linux Foundation, May 2023
- Green Digital Skills - Inco Academy, February to May 2023
- QGIS Geographic information system - Mapping GIS, June 2015
- Project Management - Chamber of the Construction Industry, March 2015
- Cadastre for managers - Agustín Codazzi Institute, June 2010

LANGUAGES Spanish native. English B2. Catalan B1.

PROJECTS

Most of my projects are available on GitHub, including educational, personal, and professional work. I typically work with MVC architectures, client-server patterns, REST APIs, as well as component-based approaches for frontend. I am also open to exploring other architectures such as microservices and hexagonal architecture under a Domain-Driven Design (DDD) approach and screaming architecture in frontend. My projects are described in more detail in my portfolio.

Jira | Trello | Illustrator | Photoshop | Figma | HTML5 | CSS3 | Sass | Bootstrap | TailwindCSS | CSS Modules | Styled-Components | Javascript | Typescript | React | NextJS | Vite | Node | Axios | Json-server | Jest | Vitest | Java | Spring Boot | JUnit | PHP | Laravel | PHPUnit | Python | MySQL | PostgreSQL | Docker | GIT | JWT | Digital Beacon | WCAG | SOLID | DRY | SCRUM | Kanban | Atomic Design